The Estée Lauder Companies (ELC)

Company Overview Estée Lauder is a famous American beauty company that owns brands like Clinique and M·A·C. They make skincare, makeup, and perfumes sold all over the world. Recently, they have been working on "Green Chemistry" to make beauty products without hurting nature.

ESG Focus: Molecular Upcycling (Lab-Grown Ingredients)



Why (The Problem)
To make high-quality creams, companies often need rare plants. Growing these plants takes a lot of land and water. Also, when plants are harvested, many parts (like seeds or skins) are just thrown away as trash, which is a waste of natural resources.

How (The Solution)
Estée Lauder started using Molecular Upcycling. Instead of planting huge fields, they use "upcycled" ingredients—like seeds left over from the juice industry—to find powerful skin nutrients. They also use fermentation (similar to how yogurt is made) in a lab to grow the ingredients they need. This means they don't need to use as much land or water.

What (The Outcome)
This creates "Active-Bio" ingredients. These are identical to natural ingredients but are much cleaner for the planet. Because they are grown in a lab or saved from fruit waste, they don't destroy forests or use up precious farmland.

Impact: By 2025, the company aims for at least 75% of its packaging to be recyclable or refillable. They are also moving toward using 100% renewable electricity for all their offices and factories.